

First Day Checklist

LX-003 Attachment | Students — Templates

Your First Legal Internship — Day One

The first day of any internship is 80% logistics and 20% work. Your job is not to impress anyone on day one — it is to observe, orient yourself, and not make a bad first impression. Use this checklist the evening before and tick items off as you go.

THE NIGHT BEFORE

☐	Confirm the reporting time, address, and floor/office <i>Reply to the offer email to confirm, or call the HR/admin contact if you haven't heard.</i>	MUST
☐	Iron and lay out your outfit <i>Business formal: shirt/kurta + trousers for men; formal salwar/saree/western formals for women. No jeans.</i>	MUST
☐	Pack your bag <i>Carry: NOC (original + 2 copies), offer letter (printed), college ID, Aadhaar/ID proof, passport photo (2), pen + notepad.</i>	MUST
☐	Research the firm briefly <i>Read the About page, note 2–3 recent matters or news items. You may be asked about your interest in the firm.</i>	SHOULD
☐	Look up your supervisor's name and designation <i>Check the firm's website or LinkedIn. Knowing who you're reporting to matters.</i>	SHOULD
☐	Charge your devices and set two alarms <i>Do not be late on Day 1 under any circumstance.</i>	MUST
☐	Get a good night's sleep <i>You will need to be alert and absorb a lot of new information.</i>	TIP

DAY ONE — HOUR-BY-HOUR

Time	What to Do / Expect
8:30 – 9:00 AM	Arrive early. Dress formally. Check the office address and floor the night before.
9:00 – 9:30 AM	Report to the reception or HR contact. Carry your NOC, ID proof, and a copy of the offer letter.
9:30 – 10:30 AM	Introduction round — you may be introduced to partners and associates. Remember names. Write them down discreetly.
10:30 AM – 12 PM	You will likely be assigned to a supervisor. They may give you your first task. Listen carefully, take notes.
12:00 – 1:00 PM	Lunch — observe the culture. Note whether people eat at their desks or go out. Follow the team's lead.
1:00 – 5:30 PM	Work on assigned task. If you finish early, ask if there is anything else needed — do not sit idle.
5:30 – 6:00 PM	Before leaving: confirm tomorrow's reporting time, check if any task is pending, thank your supervisor.

Before sleeping	Write 5 lines in your Monthly Internship Log (Resource #6) about what happened today — while it's fresh.
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WHAT TO CARRY ON DAY ONE

☐	Offer letter (printed copy)	MUST
☐	NOC from your college (original + 2 photocopies)	MUST
☐	College ID card	MUST
☐	Government photo ID (Aadhaar / PAN / Passport)	MUST
☐	2 recent passport-size photographs	SHOULD
☐	A notepad and at least 2 pens <i>Do not take notes on your phone when a partner is speaking to you — it looks casual.</i>	MUST
☐	A printed or digital copy of your CV <i>Some firms ask for it again during induction.</i>	SHOULD
☐	Any forms the firm asked you to fill in advance	MUST
☐	Water bottle and a small snack <i>You may not get a break for several hours — especially at smaller chambers.</i>	TIP

FIRST DAY ETIQUETTE — DOS AND DON'TS

DO	Arrive 10–15 minutes before the reporting time.
DO	Greet everyone you meet — seniors, peers, and support staff alike.
DO	Ask for clarification when a task is assigned — it is far better than guessing and getting it wrong.
DO	Take notes even if the task seems simple. Memory is unreliable when you are nervous.
DO	Observe the office culture before you speak too freely — every firm has a different energy.
DON'T	Use your phone during work unless told otherwise. Check messages during breaks.
DON'T	Discuss politics, religion, or personal opinions with colleagues on Day 1.
DON'T	Ask about stipend, timings, or leaves on the first day.
DON'T	Discuss other firms you've interned at in a way that compares or criticises.
DON'T	Leave early without informing your supervisor, even if you have finished your task.

END OF DAY — BEFORE YOU LEAVE

☐	Confirm tomorrow's reporting time and any pending tasks	MUST
☐	Thank your supervisor before leaving	MUST
☐	Write 5 lines in your Monthly Internship Log (Resource #6) <i>Date, task assigned, what you observed, one thing you learned, one question you have.</i>	SHOULD

☐	Send yourself a quick voice note or text summary of the day <i>Memory degrades fast — capturing it helps you improve through the internship.</i>	TIP
☐	Update the Application Tracker (Resource #5) to 'Internship Confirmed'	SHOULD

You got here. That is the hard part done. Now show up consistently, work with care, and ask the right questions — the rest will follow.

Find internship listings, firm profiles, and more resources at locusbyLexroot.in